

Week 6 Cram Sheet

Night-Before Recall + Quick Reference

Lecture 6 · Lixing Lao, Ph.D., L.Ac., MB · Topic: Inspection — Vitality, Color, Sense Organs, Hair/Nails/Skin, Secretions, Pediatric Dx

Study Order — 1) Shen 2) Su Wen 32 face map 3) Five Colors 4) Five Wheels & eye findings 5) other sense organs/tissues 6) secretions + infant vein 7) Constitution (flagged, lowest priority).

1 · Framework		Su Wen 32 — Face Heat Map	
Method	Uses	Region	Organ
Inspection	Eyes: vitality, color, appearance, secretions (incl. tongue)	L cheek (patient's)	Liver
		Forehead	Heart
Auscult./Olfact.	Ears (listen) + nose (smell)	Nose	Spleen
Inquiry	Verbal questioning	R cheek (patient's)	Lung
Palpation	Touch, incl. pulse	Chin	Kidney

Quick Recall: Zang-Xiang = inside shows outside.

Quick Recall: Face-forward pictures mirror this — patient's left is on YOUR right.

2 · Shen (Vitality)			
Observation	Having Shen	Loss of Shen	False Shen
Complexion	Bright and moist	Dim, dull sheen	Dull, then suddenly lustrous
Eyes	Alert, vivid, twinkle	Dull, blurred vision	Dull, then suddenly bright
Mind/Speech	Clear speech, conscious, agile	Unconscious, delirious	Unclear, then sudden change
Motion/Response	Quick, appropriate	Sluggish and slow	Suddenly responsive
Respiration	Even	Rapid, feeble, or difficult	Feeble, then briefly steady

Heads Up — False Shen = sudden brightening in a critical patient. Warning sign, NOT recovery.

Deranged Shen (shén luàn)

Deranged Shen	Presentation
Fán zào	Irritability + hot/feverish sensation
Zāng zào	Depression, hallucination, crying spells, no LOC
Bái hé bīng	Chronic depression, mumbling, insomnia, sleepwalking
Diǎn (Yin madness)	Chronic depression, mumbling, inappropriate laugh/cry
Kuáng (Yang madness)	Raving, aggression, wandering naked, obscenities

3 · Five Colors of Face		5 · Eyes: Five Wheels		
Color	Indication	Wheel	Structure	Organ
Red	Heat (excess=whole face; malar only=yin-def heat)	Blood	Inner/outer canthus	Heart
Pale/White	Cold, blood/yang deficiency (puffy=yang qi def; withered=blood def)	Qi	Sclera	Lung
		Wind	Iris	Liver
Yellow	Deficiency, damp (bright=yang jaundice/ damp-heat; smoky=yin jaundice)	Water	Pupil	Kidney
		Flesh	Eyelids (upper=Spleen, lower=Stomach)	Spleen/ Stomach
Blue-Green	Cold, pain, stagnation, convulsion			
Dark Grey/Black	Kidney deficiency, blood stasis			

Heads Up — Right Chi pulse = PC/San Jiao, NOT Kidney. Don't confuse w/ eye-wheel Kidney=pupil.

Quick Recall: Lustrous=good prognosis. Dark/haggard=poor prognosis.

Heads Up — Homework format = 5-color comparison table w/ case example. Expect similar on quiz.	Eye Color	
	Color	Pattern

Secretions: Color Rule		Bright yellow (tangerine-peel)	Damp-heat, heat predominant
Finding	Meaning	Dull, dusky yellow	Damp-heat, damp predominant
		Dull, dark yellow	Cold-damp
		Deep yellow + bloodshot	Toxic heat in the blood level
		Dull, dark yellow-brown	Blood stasis (dark rings, purple tongue)
4 · Appearance, Body Shape & Movement		Red (inner/outer canthus)	Heart fire (or SI, if outer canthus)
Body Shape		Red, entire eye + headache	Rising Liver fire
		Red sclera, sore throat, cough	Exterior wind-heat affecting Lung
Finding	Pattern	Color	Pattern
Overweight + depression	Qi deficiency + excess phlegm-damp	Sudden red + itching + aversion to cold	Exterior invasion of wind-heat

Movement & Posture

Finding	Pattern
Active movement	Yang syndrome
Passive manner	Yin syndrome
Violent limb movement	Wind disease (tetanus, infantile convulsion)
Muscle weakness/atrophy	Wei syndrome
Pain+swelling+restricted joints	Bi syndrome (painful obstruction)
One-sided numbness	Hemiplegia / wind-stroke
Quick movement + heat	Excess Yang
Slow movement + cold	Yang deficiency
Finding	Pattern
Small, restless fidgeting	Empty (deficiency) heat
Tremors, convulsions	Wind (involuntary movement)
Paralysis	Internal wind
Stiffness/rigidity	Qi stagnation, blood stasis, and/or wind

Quick Recall: Active/fast/hot=Yang excess. Passive/slow/cold=Yang deficiency (NOT Yin deficiency – Yin deficiency causes heat, not cold).

Eye Color (cont.)		Eye Shape/Move (cont.)	
Color	Pattern	Presentation	Pattern
Blue-green	Liver wind (tremor, dizziness, numbness, paralysis)	Deviation + nausea, vomiting, greasy coat	Wind-damp-phlegm obstruction
Bluish	Internal cold, or Kidney Yin deficiency	Both eyes deviate up/high fever/coma	Extreme heat generating wind
Dark sclera (crab-eye black)	Accumulated heat	Deviation after trauma	Blood stasis
Dark eye sockets, sunken	Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency	Congenital deviation	Essence deficiency (Kidney)
White rings around iris	Turbid phlegm	Frequent spasms, dry itchy eyes, pale, thready pulse	Blood deficiency
Cloudy white iris	Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency	Eyelids heavy/tired feeling	Spleen Qi deficiency
Pale white vessels in canthus	Blood or Yang deficiency	Occasional spasm + red/itchy + fever/chills	Exterior invasion (wind-heat)
Quick Recall: Yellow=damp, Red=heat/fire, Blue-green=wind/cold, Black/dark=extreme heat OR cold, White=deficiency/phlegm.		Droopy eyelids (ptosis)	Qi sinking, or wind attacking channels

Eye Shape & Movement

Presentation	Pattern
Bulging/protruding + anger, red tongue, yellow greasy coat	Liver Yang rising w/ heat+damp
Protruding + neck swelling, tinnitus, 5-center heat	Liver Yin def. w/ relative Yang excess
Sunken + slight cough, weak voice	Lung deficiency
Sunken + poor appetite, distention, limb weakness	Spleen deficiency
Sunken, sudden onset, deep/scattered pulse	Yin/Yang collapse (severe)
Swollen, sudden onset, no color change	Fluid malfunction (Spleen def. w/ damp)
Bags under the eyes	Spleen & Kidney deficiency
Strabismus, sudden, no redness/swelling	Wind attacking channels

6 • Nose	
Lung (5-phase) + Spleen (facial map, both Su Wen & Ling Shu).	
Finding	Pattern
Green/blue tip	Cold
Yellow tip	Damp (+heat if thirst/sweat)
White tip	Blood deficiency
Red tip	Heat
Gray tip	Impaired water → edema
Green bridge	Liver Qi stagnation
Dark purple bridge	Blood stasis
Red bridge	Liver fire
Finding	Pattern
Dry and black	Toxic heat
Flaring nostrils	Extreme heat
Epistaxis	Excess heat, blood forced out
Swollen nose	Excess condition
Sunken nose	Deficiency condition
Nasal polyps	Stagnated heat in Yangming channel
Quick Recall: Normal nose = slightly moist and shiny.	
Edema Starts In	Organ
Upper body/head	Lung
Lower body/feet	Kidney
4 limbs/torso	Spleen

7 • Ears	8 • Teeth
Kidney opens to ear.	Kidney – teeth are the "surplus of bone."

Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Swelling/pain, middle ear	Heat in the Shaoyang	White, moist, bright/clean	Strong Kidney Qi
Dry/withered/black auricle, chronic illness	Kidney essence exhausted	Dry, no sheen	Kidney Yin decline
Purulent discharge (“Tin Er”)	Damp-heat Liver/GB	Yellowing, gradual w/ age	Normal aging
Thin ear	Qi/Blood deficiency	Sudden dull yellow (soybean)	Kidney deficiency
Long, full earlobes	Strong constitution	Gray and black (black bean)	Exhaustion of Yin and Yang
Small earlobes	Poor constitution	Dry, black, gray	Kidney Yin deficiency
Shiny, moist earlobes	Good prognosis	Tartar, grimy yellow	Stomach turbidity
Dry, withered earlobes	Poor prognosis / Kidney Qi exhaustion	Burnt and dry	Kidney & Stomach Yin deficiency
Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Yellow/white pus discharge	Kidney Yin def. w/ fire, or Liver/GB damp-heat	Delayed baby/adult teeth	Essence and Jing deficiency
Ear color: white	Sudden wind-cold invasion	Deviated growth / missing	Insufficient Yangming Qi
Ear color: green/black	Pain	Loss of teeth in adult, receding gums	Fire flaring up from Kidney Yin def.
Ear color: black	Kidney failure		
Ear color: red	Excess heat (possibly damp-heat)		
Ear color: yellow	Damp accumulation		
Tinnitus	Organ		
High-pitch (cicada)	Liver		
Low-pitch (water)	Kidney		

Gums (Spleen/Stomach)		Throat & Tonsils (Stomach+Lung)	
Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Moist, deep red (normal)	Normal	Deep red throat/pharynx	Heat
Deep red + swelling	Excess heat / Stomach fire	Pale red throat	Empty (deficiency) heat
Pale	Blood deficiency	Acute pain+redness+swelling	Wind invasion (exterior)
Atrophied	Kidney deficiency	Chronic redness/swelling	Interior Stomach heat
Blue line between teeth/gums	Mercury poisoning	Chronic sore/dry, NOT swollen/red	Lung/Kidney Yin def., empty heat
Swollen, ulcerated, bleeding	Stomach fire pushing blood out	Erosion, redness, swelling, yellowish-red	Heat in Stomach/Intestines
		Chronic erosion, comes and goes	Empty (deficiency) heat
		Chronic erosion, hard raised ulcers	Blood stasis with phlegm-heat
Lips & Mouth (Spleen)		Finding	Pattern
Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Pale lips	Blood deficiency	Swollen tonsils, normal color	Damp/phlegm retention, Qi deficiency bg.
Blue-purplish lips	Retention of cold OR blood stagnation	Chronically red/swollen tonsils	Heat or toxic heat, Stomach/LI
Bright red lips	Heat toxins	Acutely red/swollen tonsils	Wind-heat invasion w/ toxicity
Crimson lips	Yin-deficiency heat	Acute red/swollen with exudate	Heat toxins, Stomach/LI (vs. cold)
Dry, red lips	Heat damaging fluids		
Purple lips	Blood stasis (stabbing pain)		
Deviated mouth	Wind		
Mouth slightly open	Deficiency pattern		
Finding	Pattern		
Mouth remains open + fever/thirst/canker sores	Excess heat		
Breathing through open mouth	Empty/deficiency pattern		
Open mouth + SOB + frothy sputum	Lung deficiency w/ phlegm stagnation		
Sudden attack, drooling, LOC	Wind		

9 · Hair		Skin	
Blood + Kidney Essence. Women ruled by Blood, men by Qi.		Finding	Pattern
Finding	Pattern	Lustrous, harmonious (normal)	Normal
		Red	Heat
		Yellow, orangish	Damp-heat, more heat than damp
		Yellow, dusky	Damp-heat, more damp than heat
		Too moist	Lung not controlling fluids
		Dry	Blood/fluid deficiency
		Dark, with scales	Blood stasis
		Itching	Wind
		Nails	Finding
Reflect the Liver.	Pitting edema (upper→down)	Yang edema, Spleen/Kidney Yang def.	
	Non-pitting edema	Qi stagnation or dampness	
	Edema from feet up, worse below	Yin edema	

Finding	Pattern	Skin Lesions	
Pink, normal luster	Sufficient Qi	Lesion	Description
Dark red	Heat	Papule	Raised, red, seed-sized; fades w/ pressure
Pale	Blood deficiency or cold	Macule	Flat red patch; does NOT fade w/ pressure
Blanch returns immediately	Sufficient Qi and Blood	Blister	Fluid-filled, thick or thin walls
Blanch returns slowly	Exhaustion of Qi and Blood	Nodule	Palpable, solid, round
Withered, dried	Liver/Kidney Yin insufficiency; chronic Bi		
Atrophied / peeled	Yin deficiency	Term	Cause
Soft and thin	Deficiency of Blood	Yong — Yang carbuncle	Internal accumulation of fire toxins
		Ju — Yin carbuncle	Insufficient Qi/Blood + Qi/Yin/cold stagnation
Finding	Pattern	Ding — boil/furuncle	Exogenous wind-fire toxins, surface heat
Rough, thick, dull, no transparency	Qi/Blood deficiency with wind	Jie — furuncle	Stagnated Qi/Blood from damp-heat in skin
Longitudinal striping	Liver Blood def., trauma, fungal infection		
Brittle	Blood deficiency, wind, or trauma		
Hook-shaped	Qi/Blood stagnation, wind-Bi		
Spoon-shaped	Qi/Blood stag., malnutrition, Spleen def.		
Ridged	Kidney Yin def., Liver Yang rising, Blood def.		
Bluish thenar veins	Cold in the Stomach		
Short bluish thenar veins	Empty (deficiency) pattern		
Finding	Pattern		
Red thenar veins	Heat		
Purple thenar veins	Blood stasis		

10 · Secretions/Excretions Logic

Applies to nasal discharge, sputum, stool, vaginal discharge alike.

Axis	Cold/Deficient	Hot/Excess
Color	White	Yellow
Consistency	Thin, clear, watery	Thick, sticky
Quantity	Profuse	Scanty
Odor	None/faint	Strong

Quick Recall: White/thin/profuse/no-odor = cold-deficiency. Yellow/thick/scanty/strong-odor = heat-excess.

11 · Infant Finger Venous Diagnosis		Vein Color	Indication
Age <3. Left index finger=boys, right index finger=girls.		Light red, not very visible	Normal
Gate Reached	Severity	Bright red	Heat
Wind Gate only	Mild illness / exterior pathogen	Purple	Stronger heat, creating stasis
Qi Gate	Interior condition, stronger illness	Green or dark blue	Wind
Life Gate	Severe illness		
Past Life Gate to tip	Life-threatening		

Recognition Traps — Common Miscalls

Trap	Correct Discriminator
Red throat = always excess	Chronic, dry, NOT swollen red throat can be Yin-deficiency empty heat instead
Open mouth = always excess	Open + fever/thirst = excess heat. Open + SOB/frothy sputum = Lung deficiency with phlegm
Purple lips = only cold	Purple can also mean Blood stasis (stabbing pain) — check for cold signs vs. stasis signs to distinguish
"Slow movement + cold" = Yin deficiency	It's Yang deficiency. Yin deficiency causes HEAT signs (five-center heat, night sweats), not cold
Any yellow finding = heat	Yellow = damp/deficiency in general; only bright/orange yellow leans heat-predominant. Dull/dark yellow leans cold-damp
Nail bed blanch test: any return = normal	Immediate return = sufficient Qi/Blood. SLOW return = exhaustion of Qi/Blood — the speed is the diagnostic, not just "does it return"
Eye wheel Kidney = Right Chi pulse Kidney	Separate systems. Eye Water Wheel (pupil) = Kidney, but Right Chi PULSE position = Pericardium/San Jiao, not Kidney
Left/right cheek = your left/right as viewer	Su Wen 32 uses the PATIENT'S own left/right. Face-forward pictures are mirrored — patient's left is on your right

Heads Up — Quiz Move — For every local sign, work it in this order: color/shape → thermal nature → excess/deficiency → organ/channel → one confirming symptom. This is the same 5-step logic tested across every section in this kit.

12 · Constitutional Types (Flagged)

Heads Up — Scope conflict: Prof. Lao's recorded lecture says "Nothing on the body constitutions" will be tested. Prof. Schrier's own deck devotes ~9/41 slides to it. Confirm with him which governs the quiz.

Weak vs. Strong Constitution (Ling Shu 54)

Marker	Weak	Strong
Eyes/nose/ears/mouth	Close together	Well-proportioned
Space between eyebrows	Small	Broad forehead/glabella
Nose	Narrow, flared	Straight, well-formed
Philtrum	Short	Long
Cheeks	Thin	Full, normal luster
Jaw	Flat, sunken, narrow	Strong, even, smooth
Ears	Small, short lobes	Long, long lobes
Muscles/skin	Flabby, loose	Firm

Cause of Weak Constitution	Five-Element Body Types (Ling Shu 64)		
Parents' general health			
Health at time of conception	Element	Physical	Personality
Mother's health during pregnancy	Wood	Green complexion, small head, long face, broad shoulders, tall, sinewy	Superior talent, hardworking, survives sickness
Parental age/pregnancy events (stress, trauma, drugs/alcohol/smoking)			
Heads Up — Constitution is not fixed: Pre-Heavenly (Jing) essence is the basis; Post-Heavenly Qi (diet, herbs, acupuncture, <i>yang sheng</i>) can improve it.	Fire	Red complexion, small head/hands/feet, curly/little hair, walks fast+sways	Frivolous w/ wealth, passionate, impulsive, curious

Quick Recall: Wood=tall/hardworking. Fire=curly/impulsive. Earth=round/calm. Metal=square/honest. Water=dark/deceptive.